

Rook Ashfall — Variant Human Ranger (Hunter — Colossus Slayer)



Figure 1: Character portrait

Class: Ranger (Hunter, Colossus Slayer feature locked) **Race:** Variant Human (Sharpshooter feat at L1)
Level: 3 **Role:** Sharpshooter archer — high sustained ranged DPR with Hunter's Mark + Colossus Slayer stacking **Personality Hook:** *Counts arrows, not kills. Says the arrow knows where it needs to land — he just lets it go.*

Core Stats

Ability Scores (Point Buy 27, +Variant Human +1 DEX / +1 WIS + Sharpshooter feat)

Ability	Score	Mod
STR	10	+0
DEX	16	+3
CON	14	+2
INT	10	+0
WIS	15	+2
CHA	10	+0

Combat Vitals

- **HP:** 34 (base 24 at L3 with CON 14 + **10 HP variant buffer**)
- **AC:** 15 (Studded Leather 12 + DEX 3)
- **Speed:** 30 ft
- **Initiative:** +3
- **Proficiency Bonus:** +2
- **Hit Dice:** 3d10

Saving Throws: STR +2, DEX +5

Skill Proficiencies: Perception +4, Stealth +5, Survival +4, Nature +2, Athletics +2

Senses: (none special)

Languages: Common, plus one extra (Variant Human bonus language)

Equipment

- **Longbow** (1d8 piercing, ranged **150/600**, two-handed, heavy) — primary weapon
- **2x Shortsword** (1d6 piercing, finesse, light) — off-melee if pulled into close range
- **Quiver + 20 Arrows** (assume sufficient ammo at match start)
- **Studded Leather Armor**
- **Explorer's Pack**
- **Starting trinket:** A single black arrow with no fletching — kept but never drawn

Class & Race Features

Ranger (L3)

- **Favored Enemy:** Picks two humanoid types — **Humans + Orcs** (most likely opponents in roster). **Advantage on INT checks to track them, WIS checks to recall info, learn one of their languages.** Functionally flavor in PVP; real value only if map encounters use those creature types.
- **Natural Explorer:** Picks one favored terrain — **Forest**. Doubles proficiency bonus for related INT/WIS checks; travel bonuses. Map-dependent.
- **Fighting Style (L2) — Archery:** **+2 to attack rolls** made with ranged weapons. Huge.
- **Spellcasting (WIS):** Spell save DC **12**, spell attack **+4**. Slots: **3× L1** (no L2 until Ranger L5).
- **Ranger Archetype — Hunter (L3):**
 - **Hunter's Prey — Colossus Slayer:** Once per turn, when you hit a creature that has **less than its maximum HP**, add **+1d8 damage** to the hit. (Easy to trigger after Round 1 or against any pre-damaged target.)
- **Primeval Awareness (L3):** Spend a spell slot to sense certain creature types within 1 mi (6 mi in favored terrain). Town/scouting utility, not a combat tool.

Variant Human

- **+1 to two ability scores** (DEX + WIS baked in above)
- **One extra skill proficiency** (Perception, baked in)
- **Feat at L1 — Sharpshooter:**
 - **Ignore long-range disadvantage** (Longbow effective range = 600 ft with no penalty)
 - **Attacks ignore half and three-quarters cover**
 - **-5 to hit / +10 damage.** Variant rules adjust this to **-3 / +6** (per rules-variant-level-3.md) — use the -3/+6 numbers below.

Signature Tactical Moves

1. **The Mark-and-Snipe (every round from turn 1).** Bonus action: **Hunter's Mark** on priority target (L1 slot, 1 min concentration). Action: Longbow attack with **Sharpshooter -3/+6**. To hit math: +2 prof + 3 DEX + 2 Archery = +7 base, **-3 Sharpshooter = +4 to hit**. Damage: 1d8 + 3 DEX + 6 Sharpshooter + 1d6 Hunter's Mark + 1d8 Colossus Slayer (if target wounded) = **avg 4.5 + 3 + 6 + 3.5 + 4.5 = ~21.5 per hit**. Repeats every turn for up to 1 minute.
2. **Pull and Kite.** Wood Elf-style kite loop on the short side of 30 ft speed: shoot from max range, move to maintain distance, **Sharpshooter ignores long-range disadvantage** so it doesn't matter how far back you peel. Against melee characters (Barbarian, Paladin) who rely on closing, this is the anti-rush move. Hunter's Mark also **transfers to a new target for free** if the current target drops (bonus action reactivation).
3. **Up-Close Dual-Shortsword Emergency.** Pulled into melee? **Swap to shortwords** (free object interaction + action interaction per turn). Two-Weapon Fighting: Action Shortsword main hand (1d6+3 = 6.5 avg) + Bonus action Shortsword off-hand (1d6 = 3.5 avg, no DEX mod on damage without TWF style). Plus Hunter's Mark d6 + Colossus Slayer d8 on main hand = avg 14.5. Not great, but not dead. **Tactical note:** if you're in melee, use Bonus Action on re-positioning, not a second swing. Move away, keep Longbow up next turn.

Action Economy (Quick Reference)

Slot	Options
Action	Longbow Attack (+4 to hit w/ Sharpshooter -3, 150/600 ignore long-range) · Shortsword melee (+5, 1d6+3) · Cast Cure Wounds / Ensnaring Strike · Dash · Dodge · Hide
Bonus Action	Hunter's Mark (cast or re-target, L1 slot) · Off-hand Shortsword (TWF, only in melee)
Reaction	Opportunity Attack
Movement	30 ft
Concentration slot	Hunter's Mark (primary) · OR Ensnaring Strike · OR Goodberry (non-concentration)

Spells

Spell Save DC 12 / Spell Attack +4 (WIS, 3× L1 slots)

Spells Known (3 at L3):

- **Hunter's Mark** — Bonus action, concentration, **1 min**, 90 ft. Mark a creature → **+1d6 damage on every weapon hit against it**. Advantage on Survival/Perception to track it. **If the target drops, re-target as a bonus action** (no new slot spent). This is the spell — always have it up.
- **Cure Wounds** — Action, touch, 1d8 + 2 = avg 6.5 heal. Team emergency heal when he's next to a downed ally (rare for an archer — mostly Goodberry covers him).

- **Goodberry** — Action, creates 10 berries, each heals 1 HP + a day's sustenance. Prep during town phase — **10 free HP of healing for the team in match.**

Damage Reference

With Hunter's Mark up + target wounded (i.e. post-Round-1 in most fights):

- **Longbow + Sharpshooter:** +4 to hit, $1d8 + 3 + 6 + 1d6$ (HM) + $1d8$ (Colossus Slayer) = **avg ~21.5 damage**
- **Longbow without Sharpshooter:** +7 to hit, $1d8 + 3 + 1d6 + 1d8$ = avg ~15.5 (use vs. high-AC targets like plate-armor Paladin)
- **Longbow no mark, no Colossus Slayer:** +7 to hit, $1d8 + 3$ = avg 7.5 (Round 1 before Hunter's Mark setup, if you prioritize moving into position instead)
- **Shortsword main-hand (in melee + HM):** $1d6 + 3 + 1d6 + 1d8$ = avg 14.5
- **Shortsword off-hand TWF:** $1d6$ = avg 3.5 (no DEX without TWF fighting style)

Decision tree for Sharpshooter: Use **-3/+6** vs. targets with AC 15 (Barbarian AC 15, Cleric AC 18 w/shield, Rogue AC 15, Bard AC 14, Wizard AC 13). **Drop it** vs. the Paladin (AC 18) — the -3 swings math against you. Against Fighter (AC 18 with chain mail + shield) similar — drop Sharpshooter, take the +7 base.

Town Phase Notes

- **Perception +4 + Survival +4 + Nature +2** — strong scout. Good at finding hidden Catacombs entrances and Neutral Titan spawns (if map has one).
- **Stealth +5** — viable partner for the Rogue on pickpocket runs.
- **Goodberry prep** — cast 1× L1 slot during town phase **before combat starts** → carry 10 berries into the match for free emergency heals (1 HP each, or snack for sustenance). Eat as an object interaction; no concentration.
- **Primeval Awareness** — if the map has ambient creatures (neutral monster, fey, etc.) burn a slot to ping them; otherwise skip.
- Weak at raw-CHA stations (Haggling, Casino, Tavern). Zero INT/CHA bonuses.